

Brian Harward, PhD

Research Scientist | Psychometrics, People Analytics, and Measurement

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Organizational psychologist (PhD) and research scientist with 15+ years turning organizational questions into measurement that holds up. I design and validate assessments and surveys, run the analysis, and translate findings for executives, boards, and non-technical teams, across pre-employment assessment, employee listening and culture measurement, and applied behavioral research for Fortune 500, government, nonprofit, and education clients. I have been the sole research function for a think tank, an analytics department lead, and a university research director, always remote.

"He tackled any and all projects from beginning to end (design, methods, analysis, presentation), always producing work of the highest quality."

Jonathan Haidt, Professor, NYU Stern School of Business, who managed me directly at Ethical Systems

Skills

Measurement	Psychometric validation, item response theory, factor analysis (EFA/CFA), reliability, construct and criterion validity, DIF and measurement invariance, adverse impact and fairness analysis, EEOC/UGESP standards, job analysis, competency modeling
Research & analytics	Survey design, weighting, scale development, experimental and quasi-experimental design, mixed-effects and regression models, segmentation, conjoint, longitudinal analysis, interviews and focus groups, employee listening, driver analysis, selection and assessment programs
Tools & partnership	R, Python, SQL, SPSS, SAS, Stata, Mplus, BigQuery, Tableau, Power BI, Qualtrics, Excel. Executive interviewing and advisory, data storytelling, white papers, facilitation, teaching and mentoring, remote collaboration

Education & Recognition

PhD, Organizational Psychology, Walden University, 2014. • **BA, Psychology**, Wright State University. • **Distinguished Faculty Award**, teaching statistics.

Experience

Chief Scientific Officer (Part-time), SciRec 03/2024 – Present

- Designed, validated, and launched eight pre-employment assessments in seven months, each from theory through full psychometric validation.
- Built the measurement foundation: item response theory, factor analysis, reliability, convergent and construct validity, and bias and sensitivity (DIF) testing.

Consultant & Research Scientist, Ethical Systems @ NYU Stern School of Business 08/2019 – 06/2024

- Served as the organization's sole research function, owning projects from problem framing through design, methods, analysis, and executive presentation.
- Co-authored a six-article series on the behavioral science of fairness for the Government Finance Officers Association, 21,000+ members.
- Designed and validated an organizational Ethical Culture Scale, a 20-item, 5-factor instrument now free for academic use.

Consultant & Research Scientist, Significant Difference LLC 01/2012 – Present

- Led end-to-end research, measurement, and evaluation for 200+ clients across industry, government, nonprofit, and education.
- Built and validated instruments in applied settings, including an adaptability assessment for employment screening and multiple client-specific scales.

Consultant (Part-time), MH Partners 05/2024 – Present

- Advise boards on risk, reputation, and strategy, translating stakeholder and market dynamics into actionable recommendations.

Lead Research Analyst, TrendSource Inc., Insights Department 01/2017 – 04/2018

- Led the analytics department, including hiring, and mentored analysts in advanced methods.
- Designed and executed mixed-methods research end to end for multi-billion-dollar and international clients.

Director of Research & Faculty Member, San Diego University for Integrative Studies 01/2012 – 12/2016

- Directed institutional research and measurement frameworks that overhauled student-success outcomes; supervised doctoral candidates through design, IRB compliance, analysis, and defense; interviewed, hired, and assessed faculty.
- Taught graduate and undergraduate statistics and research methods. Recipient of the Distinguished Faculty Award for teaching statistics.

Selected Work

What's Fair? The Behavioral Science of Justice and Fairness. *Government Finance Officers Association*. Lead author of a six-article series with Alison Taylor and Shayne Kavanagh.

Ethical Culture Scale. *Ethical Systems @ NYU Stern*. Development and validation of a 20-item, 5-factor organizational measure, free for academic use.

Adaptability Assessment. *T Labs*. Led validation of a pre-employment instrument. • **SPSS Linear Regression.** *Udemy*. 3,400+ students.

Recommendations

Brian Harward, PhD

Written on LinkedIn, where they can be read in full and verified: [linkedin.com/in/brianharward](https://www.linkedin.com/in/brianharward)

Jonathan Haidt

Professor, NYU Stern School of Business; author of *The Anxious Generation*, *The Coddling of the American Mind*, *The Righteous Mind*, and *The Happiness Hypothesis*. Managed Brian directly at Ethical Systems. August 2025.

I had the privilege of working with Brian Harward for four years at Ethical Systems, where he handled an extraordinary range of research initiatives with depth, independence, and intellectual rigor. As our sole research staff member, he tackled any and all projects from beginning to end (design, methods, analysis, presentation), always producing work of the highest quality. He also contributed thought leadership through consulting engagements, blogs, and research pages that advanced innovative ideas in business ethics and organizational culture. Brian's ability to think strategically, synthesize complex concepts, and communicate them with clarity made him invaluable to our mission. I recommend him for any role requiring critical thinking and a commitment to meaningful impact.

Alison Taylor

Clinical Professor, NYU Stern School of Business; author of *Higher Ground* (HBR Press). Managed Brian directly at Ethical Systems. February 2024.

Brian Harward is a brilliant researcher, analyst, writer, and colleague. We have worked closely together for four years, and I could not recommend his thoughtful approach and sharp analysis more highly.

Lisa Bulgatz, PhD

Director of Student Services, San Diego University for Integrative Studies. Worked with Brian for six years. April 2024.

Dr. Harward was responsible to provide supervision to doctoral candidates and their research projects, including in the design of research protocols; to explain the applicable federal and state regulations and institutional policies for conducting studies with human participants; advise on the appropriate methods for data gathering and recording, statistical analysis and interpretation of results. Dr. Harward has an innate ability to connect with students, and consistently received positive student evaluations.

Brian Cash

Quantitative Analyst. Reported directly to Brian Harward. January 2024.

Brian was the analytics manager and my direct supervisor at a market research company we worked at together. It was my first job after grad school and Brian was an excellent mentor and manager. Not only did I learn a ton from his deep and varied knowledge of research and statistics, but his management style and easygoing nature provided me an ideal balance of support and room for independent growth and exploration. I really enjoyed working with him and any company or junior employee would be lucky to have him.

Dan Green, PhD MBA

Business Transformation Executive, Professor, 3x best-selling author. Client. March 2017.

I highly recommend Brian for any business or research statistical work for two simple reasons: expertise and ease. I have used Brian on multiple occasions for statistical work and business analysis, and he always delivers on time, on budget, and he develops a precision product. I don't know of any other statisticians that have his level of expertise in the subject or are easier to work with.

Recommendations are quoted from LinkedIn. Some longer entries are excerpted; all are available in full at [linkedin.com/in/brianharward](https://www.linkedin.com/in/brianharward).